

Module 1

I. Life Skills identified by WHO

6. Decision Making

It is the act of choosing between the possible solutions to a problem. Decision can be made through either an intuitive or reasoned process.

- * Decision making is an important aspect of problem solving
- * The selection of the most suitable outcome is based on the analysis of the advantages and disadvantages of all the proposed solutions.
- * It involves the reviewing of the impact of the decision and amending the course of action as required
- * Types of decision making:-

a) Intuition based

It is the process of decision making based on a 'gut feeling' rather than reason and logic. This type of a problem solving is handy to make quick decisions. It takes a person to have a considerable amount of experience to make such quick decision.

b) Logic based

Logic based decision making involves a proper analysis of the impact of all the possible solutions to the problem. It is a systematic process of addressing the issue using logic and reasoning.

7. Effective Communication

Communication is the process of conveying information. Communication is said to be effective when all the parties (sender and receiver) perceive the intended meaning of the information conveyed.

- * In the business context, communication is said to be effective when the shared information contributes towards the betterment of the organization.
- * Effective communication involves Non- verbal communication, emotional intelligence, active listening and communication skills.
- * It enables the employees to improve team- work, Problem solving and decision making.

8. Interpersonal relationship

- * A strong bond between two or more people refers to interpersonal relationship.
- * Various instances of interpersonal relationship include,

a) Individuals working in the same organization

b) People working in the same team

c) Relationship between family members

d) Relationship between friends.

* The very base of family and the society as a whole is the strong bond of interpersonal relationships

* Individuals in an interpersonal relationship must share a sense of trust respect for each other's views and opinions.

* Transparency and honesty play pivotal role in developing strong interpersonal relationships.

9. Coping with Stress

* Coping is the process of managing personal and interpersonal problems.

* Coping with Stress involves strategies to reduce the intensity of the stress

* Feeling emotional and nervous can be normal reaction to stress

* Stress can create pressure, affect our digestive system and immune system,

* Stress can cause depression

* Some healthy ways to deal with Stress include :-

1. Exercise on a regular basis

2. Eat healthy and well- balanced diet

3. Talk to others

4. Avoid drugs and alcohol

5. Journaling for stress management

Journaling for stress management

* Journaling for stress management is to write in detail about feelings and thoughts related to stressful events

* It can act as a stress management and self-exploration tool

* works best when done consistently

* It helps one process them by fully exploring and releasing the emotions involved.

Health benefits of journaling

- * Journaling decreases the effects of stress on health
- * It improves cognitive functioning
- * It can counteract many of the negative effects of stress
- * Journaling is a viable option for the disabled.

*Eg: The diary of a young girl also known as The Diary of Anne Frank (It is a book of the writings from the Dutch-language diary kept by Anne Frank while she was in hiding for two years with her family during the Nazi occupation of the Netherlands.)

10. Coping with Emotions

It is the ability understand the feelings in ourselves and others and being aware of how emotions influence behaviour

- * It involves regulating your feelings and emotional response to the problem
- * Letting rationality take control of the situation as far as possible ·

Types of Emotions:-

- * Positive emotions - Joy , love
- * Makes you feel good
- * We need to keep a check on our emotion as the situation persists

Negative emotions

- * Guilt, anger
- * Make you feel bad
- * They often narrow down your perspective

II. Life Skills for Professionals

1. Positive Thinking

Positive thinking is a mental attitude in which you expect good and favourable result. A positive mind waits for happiness, health and happy ending in any situation.

- * Successful people have a lifestyle around positive Thinking

- * A person who faces life with a positive attitude will always be succeed in life both professionally and personally

- * The health benefits of positive thinking include- increased life span, lower rates of depression, lower level of distress etc.

- * It is beneficial for our mental health because it acts as a source of motivation

2. Right Attitude

- * The term right Attitude refers to the positive outlook of an individual through the ups and downs in life

- * While positive Thinking acts as a source of inspiration, one's attitude determines the course of action.

- * It is the guide to leading a positive life.

- * A positive attitude is essential to happiness, joy and progress in life

- * It helps us to cope with the daily affairs of life

- * It brings optimism into life and makes it easier to avoid worried and negative thinking

- * Right Attitude can bring constructive changes to one's life

3. Intelligence Quotient (IQ)

- *The term IQ is coined by psychologist William Stern

- * Intelligence Quotient (IQ) represents an individual's level of intelligence, capacity for reasoning, logical thinking, problem solving etc. Inshort it is regarded as the measure of an individual's intelligence.

- * It is derived by a system of standard tests assessing the intellectual capacity of an individual.

- * To calculate IQ, a person's mental age as determined by standard sets is divided by chronological age and the result is multiplied by 100

- *
$$IQ = \text{mental age} / \text{chronological age} \times 100$$

- * Most people (about 68 percent) have an IQ between 85 and 115. Only a small fraction of people have a very low IQ (below 70) or a very high IQ (above 130).

- * Some famoys IQ tests are - Mensa IQ test, Weschller intelligence scale etc

4. Emotional Quotient (EQ)

Emotional quotient refers to an individual's ability to understand, use and manage one's own emotions in a positive way to deal with the challenges of life.

- * Inshort it is the ability of a person to manage his own and other's emotions

- * It involves self management, self awareness, social awareness and relationship management
- * Successful people maintain a good level of emotional intelligence
- * Emotional intelligence helps to build stronger relationships
- * It helps in success at your academics and workplace
- * It can help you achieve your career and personal goals

Differences between IQ & EQ

IQ	EQ
IQ is a number obtained from standardized intelligence test, which represents an individual's ability of logical reasoning.	EQ refers to an individual's level of emotional intelligence, which is represented by scores obtained in a standardized test.
Measures General Intelligence	Measures Emotional Intelligence
Learn, understand and implement knowledge, logical reasoning and abstract thinking.	Recognize, control and express one's own emotion's, perceive and assess other's emotion's.
Recognizes People with high intellect, common sense, mental challenges, etc.	Leaders, Captains, Managers and people with social challenges.
IQ measures a person's academic competency and reasoning ability.	EQ measures an individual's social and emotional competencies or one's ability to recognise one's own and other person's emotional expression.

5. SQ (Social Quotient)

It is the measure of a person's ability to connect positively with others and build a network of relationships.

- * It is the ability to work together, cooperate and manage good relationships
- * A socially intelligent person knows better to play different social roles making him/ her comfortable with different types of people.
- * Significance of SQ :-
 1. People with high SQ can better understand the needs of others
 2. Such people are natural leaders who can lead the organisation forward by addressing the issues more effectively
 3. They can get along with people from different socio- cultural backgrounds
 4. Individuals having high levels of SQ can work as a productive team towards a common objective

6. Attention to Detail

It is the ability to complete a task showing thorough concern for all the areas no matter how small.

- * It helps to prevent mistakes and ensure success of a project/ assignment
- * Minute details can have significant impact or consequences
- * Eg: Forgetting to add an attachment in email, In computer programming strings or signs or letters can change the result
- * Significance- Ensures completeness and accuracy of facts.

7. Having the Big picture

It implies that While focusing on the details the bigger picture should not be left unseen

- * It refers to the habit of thinking big into every aspect of life
- * For instance, a technology you have learnt, how it can revolutionise the industry, eg: Lithium - ion batteries used in electric cars
- * In short having tge big picture means to think big
- * It requires a person to see things from a wider and far- reaching perspective

8. Learning Skills

The skills that help one to learn and retain things better could be termed as Learning skills. It includes skills such as creative Thinking, critical Thinking, communication etc.

- * It is a skill that helps in ones's career as well as person life.
- * The 21st century learning skills are called the 4 C's- Critical Thinking, creative thinking, communication, Collaboration

9. Research skills

Research skills are the ability to find an answer to a question or a solution to a problem through a systematic approach.

- * It provides in depth information
- * Important research skills include- scientific temperament, problem solving, attention to detail, writing skills and ability to arrive at conclusion

10. Perseverance

Perseverance is the ability of an individual to keep doing something in spite of the obstacles or failures

- * Perseverance is one key quality that can lead you to success
- * It reflects an individual's level of determination
- * It shows an individual's strength of character

11. Setting goals and achieving them

The term 'goals' in life refers to the things you want to achieve in your life

- * Goal setting helps you achieve your goal in a focused, decisive and time bound manner
- * Experts have identified an effective method/ strategy fulfil the goals of life namely 'SMART' approach towards goal setting

S - specific

M- measurable

A- attainable

R - relevant

T - time- bound

- * Specific- make your goal specific and narrow for more effective planning
- * Measurable- evaluate what evidence will prove you're making progress and re-evaluate if and when necessary
- * Attainable- make sure you can reasonably accomplish your goal within a certain time frame
- * Relevant- your goals should align with your values and long term objectives
- * Time bound- set realistic time frame for task prioritisation and motivation

12. Motivation

Motivation is a person's drive towards achieving a set goal of life. It is more like a stimulation to push one to a desired course of action

- * The process of motivation involves needs, drives and goals
- * Different types of motivation -

1) Extrinsic motivation - Motivation arising from factors outside us. Many employment motivation systems work based on this principle.

- * Rewards, punishments, emoluments etc are forms of extrinsic motivation factors.

- * Effective for simple activities
- * It Can't help a person to be self driven

2) Intrinsic motivation

- * Motivation not arising from external factors
- * It is an inner drive towards a goal of life
- * People are usually find intrinsic motivation towards works of their interest
- * Various instances of intrinsic motivation include
 - a) Reading a book to learn something new or for fun
 - c) Participating in a sport because its fun and you enjoy it

3) Identified Motivation

Identified motivation refers to a form of motivation which occurs as understanding or feeling the need to perform or accomplish some task but not yet acting on this need.

- * This is a powerful form of intrinsic motivation that prepares the person to act.
- * This form of motivation can create lasting accomplishments

4) Introjected Motivation

The type of motivation that is driven by a sense of obligation

- * Introjected regulation inspires an individual to enact a behavior not because he wants to, but he is forced by an internal pressure
- * The source of motivation for such a behavior can be - guilt, worry or shame.